

Date: 2 October 2026

1. Category definitions

Label by the financial product or service the complaint is mainly about, not by every product the customer mentions.

Category	Belongs here	Typical keywords	Use a different category if
Credit reporting	Errors or disputes about a credit report or score; a credit bureau's handling of a dispute; identity theft whose main harm is entries on the report	Equifax, Experian, TransUnion; "inaccurate", "dispute", "hard inquiry", "remove from my report"	The complaint is mainly about a debt collector's calls, letters or threats. Use Debt collection. If a collector's debt is on the report but the customer asks for the entry to be corrected or removed, keep Credit reporting.
Debt collection	Attempts to collect a debt: calls, letters, threats, debt not owed, no validation, collector lawsuits	"collection agency", "collector", "validation letter", "keeps calling"	The original lender is billing the customer for its own active account. Use Mortgage, Credit card or Consumer loan. If the customer's request is to correct or remove the entry from their credit report, use Credit reporting.
Mortgage	Home loans and their servicing: payments, escrow, modification, foreclosure, refinancing, home equity loans/HELOC	"servicer", "escrow", "loan modification", "foreclosure"	The loan is not secured on a home, such as a car, personal or student loan. Use Consumer loan.
Credit card	Credit card accounts: billing, fees, interest, rewards, disputed charges, card fraud, card applications	"statement", "APR", "chargeback", "card issuer"	The card is a debit card linked to a bank account. Use Bank account or service. If card fraud has been dealt with and what remains is a wrong entry on the credit report that the customer wants removed, use Credit reporting.
Bank account or service	Checking and savings accounts: deposits, withdrawals, overdraft fees, holds, account opening or closing, debit cards. Also covers the customer's own account with a payment app or platform (PayPal, Cash App, Venmo, crypto exchanges or wallets, prepaid or debit-card apps) when the problem is with the account itself.	"checking account", "overdraft", "branch", "funds on hold"	The customer sent money to another person or company, by wire, Zelle or PayPal, and the transfer went wrong or was a scam. Use Money transfer or service.
Consumer loan	Non-mortgage loans: vehicle loans and leases, personal and installment loans, student loans, payday loans	"auto loan", "car", "lease", "student loan", "installment"	The debt is on a credit card (use Credit card), or the loan is for a home or is a HELOC (use Mortgage).

Money transfer or service	Money the customer sent between people or institutions: wires, Zelle, PayPal, Venmo, Western Union, money orders, virtual currency, transfer scams.	"wire", "sent money", "Zelle", "PayPal", "Bitcoin", "Coinbase"	The problem is fees, holds, freezes, closure, or money leaving the customer's own account without their permission (including PayPal, Cash App or crypto accounts), rather than a transfer the customer sent. Use Bank account or service.
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2. Decision rules

Apply these in order. The first rule that settles the ticket wins.

1. **Main complaint test.** Ask: "What does the customer want fixed?" Label the product that request is about. The background story does not count.
2. **Collector vs credit report.** If a collector is chasing a debt and the debt also appears on the credit report, choose Debt collection when the complaint is about the collector's conduct, stopping collection, a refund of money paid to the collector, or whether the debt is owed. Choose Credit reporting when the customer's request is to correct or remove the report entry, even if they also asked the collector for validation or say the debt is not theirs, or when the complaint is about the bureau's dispute process.
3. **Identity theft.** Choose the category based on where the customer was harmed. If fraudulent accounts or wrong entries appeared on their credit report, label it Credit reporting. If someone made unauthorized charges on their credit card, label it Credit card. If money was taken from their bank account or their own payment app account, label it Bank account or service. If a debt collector is chasing them for a debt the fraudster created, label it Debt collection. If the harm landed in more than one place, label by the harm the customer still wants fixed (rule 1).
4. **Money leaving an account.** If the customer sent money to someone else, for example by wire, Zelle, PayPal or cryptocurrency, and the transfer went wrong or turned out to be a scam, label it Money transfer or service. If the problem is with the customer's own account itself, such as fees, holds, freezes, the account being closed, or money leaving it without their permission, label it Bank account or service. This applies to the provider, including PayPal, Cash App, Venmo and crypto platforms.
5. **Original lender vs collector.** If the original lender or servicer is collecting on its own account, label by the product (Mortgage, Credit card, Consumer loan), not Debt collection. Use Debt collection when a third-party agency or debt buyer is involved, or the customer says the debt is not theirs, unless rule 2 has already settled the ticket as Credit reporting.
6. **Fits none.** If no category fits well, choose the closest one. Do not invent a new category: the service must output one of these seven.
7. **Vague or too short.** If the narrative does not say enough to decide, make your best guess.
8. **Ignore the original label.** You will not see it. Do not look it up.

3. Labelling procedure

1. Read this whole protocol once before starting. Keep it open while labelling.
2. Each labeller works on their own copy of the label sheet (Annotator A or B). Do not discuss tickets, compare answers, or share sheets until both are finished.
3. For each ticket, read the full narrative, apply Section 1 and the rules in Section 2, and choose one category from the dropdown.

- Do not run any model on these tickets, search for them online, or look up their original labels.
- When finished, save the sheet as Annotator____.xlsx and commit it to the repository unchanged. These independent sheets are submitted as evidence.

4. Agreement, disagreement resolution and revisions

After both sheets are committed, compute **Cohen's kappa** between Annotator A and Annotator B over all tickets. Report it with raw percentage agreement. As a guide, kappa above 0.6 is substantial and above 0.8 is near-perfect agreement.

Then resolve each disagreement:

- List every ticket where A and B chose different categories.
- Both labellers meet, reread the narrative, and agree on a final label using this protocol.
- Record each resolution in the resolution log: row, A's label, B's label, final label, and the reason.
- If a disagreement shows the protocol is unclear or missing a rule, add or change the rule, increase the version number, and record it in the revision log below. Relabel any earlier tickets affected by the change.
- Once all disagreements are resolved, commit the final golden set (row number and final label) **before any model is run**.

Cohen's Kappa and Raw Agreement

- Cohen's Kappa = 0.82** (near-perfect)
- Raw Agreement = 84.7%** (127 of 150 tickets)
- 23 disagreements resolved below

Resolution log (one row per disagreement)

Row	Annotator A Owen	Annotator B Russell	Final label	Reason / rule applied
5761	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rules 4 and 7 (v1.1). Narrative never describes the customer sending money to anyone, so the problem is with their own account, not a transfer that went wrong.
5549	Credit reporting	Debt collection	Credit reporting	Rules 2 and 3 (v1.1). The customer's explicit request is that it "stop reporting... and be removed immediately from my credit report", which is exactly rule 2's condition for Credit reporting.
5527	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rules 3 and 4 (v1.1). Money disappeared from the customer's own Cash App account, or was sent to random Cash App users without their permission. Customer did not send it, so this is not a transfer that "went wrong". It is unauthorised use of their own account, which rule 3 and 4 both place under Bank account.
5235	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rule 4 (v1.1). PayPal is holding \$10 and won't let the customer close the account for 90 days. The Money transfer row's "use a different category if" column says holds or closure on the customer's

				own account go to Bank account. No transfer is in dispute.
5986	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rules 4 and 7 (v1.1). Same cash app template as row 5761, with the same reasoning.
5139	Consumer loan	Money transfer or service	Consumer loan	Rules 1, 5 and 7. The customer cancelled an order. The payment provider paid the merchant in full and now wants the customer to repay the full amount for goods they never received. That pattern matches buy-now-pay-later installment credit, which falls under Consumer loan.
5059	Credit reporting	Debt collection	Credit reporting	Rule 2 (v1.1). The request is to have it "deleted from all credit reporting agencies". The customer complains of no calls, letters or threats from a collector. The complaint is about inaccurate reporting and how the dispute was handled.
5837	Credit card	Credit reporting	Credit reporting	Rules 1 and 3 (v1.1). A stolen wallet led to fraudulent card transactions, but under rule 1 that is background. The title is "FALSE LATE PAYMENT ON MY REPORT", and the customer keeps returning to "it remains on my credit report" and "hurting my credit". Rule 3 labels by where the harm landed, and the unresolved harm is the wrong entry on the credit report.
5578	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rule 4 (v1.1). The crypto trading account was restricted after ID re-verification, and the customer can't withdraw their remaining balance. This is a restriction on their own account, not a transfer they sent. "Virtual currency" alone doesn't decide the category.
5542	Credit card	Bank account or service	Credit card	Rule 3. The customer reported it as credit card fraud. Unauthorised charges on a credit card mean Credit card. The Regions bank card only paid the authorised \$50 deposit and the monthly payments, and there is no problem with the bank account itself.
5543	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rule 4 (v1.1). The account was frozen after the customer sent photo ID and bank statements, and they can't move about \$600 out. That is a hold on their own account. The provider isn't named, so nothing supports Money transfer.
5107	Credit reporting	Debt collection	Credit reporting	Rule 2 (v1.1). The end request is removal, and no collector conduct such as calls or threats is complained about. This matches ticket 5023, which both annotators labelled Credit reporting.
5652	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rules 3 and 4 (v1.1). This is unauthorised use of their own account, not a transfer the customer chose to send.
5589	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rules 4 and 7 (v1.1). Same cash app template as 5761, with the same reasoning.
5066	Credit reporting	Debt collection	Credit reporting	Rules 3 and 2 (v1.1). Rule 3 sends identity theft to Debt collection only when a collector is chasing the customer, but the narrative says IQ Data "did not contact me at all". The only harm is the wrong entry on the credit report.
5063	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rule 4 (v1.1). The crypto purchase itself went through. Gemini then deactivated the customer's account, and they can't withdraw their \$1,000. The problem is the closure and freeze of their own account.
5534	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rule 4 (v1.1). Cash App closed the customer's account "for no reason" and won't let them open a new one. That is closure of their own account.
5425	Debt collection	Credit card	Debt collection	Rules 1 and 6. What they want fixed is the collection of a debt they don't owe, so Debt collection is the closest category.

5583	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rule 4 (v1.1). Cash App locked the account for identity verification, and the customer can't reach their funds or pay bills. That is a hold on their own account.
5265	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rule 4 (v1.1). PayPal is holding the funds for 120 days over "unusual activity". The earlier transfers the customer mentions are background. What they want fixed is the hold on their own account.
5995	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rules 4 and 7 (v1.1). Same cash app template as 5761, with the same reasoning.
5055	Bank account or service	Money transfer or service	Bank account or service	Rules 4 and 7 (v1.1). Same Cash App template as 5761, with the same reasoning.
5072	Credit reporting	Debt collection	Credit reporting	Rule 2 (v1.1). The customer's request is "I would like it removed off of my credit report". Rule 3's last clause could point to Debt collection because the collector is chasing them, but rule 2 comes first and is decided by that request.

Revision log

Version	Date	Change	Triggered by (row)
v1.0	28/9/2026	Initial protocol agreed by the team	-
v1.1	2/10/2026	Rule 4 clarified: "the customer's own account" includes accounts with non-bank providers such as PayPal, Cash App, Venmo, crypto exchanges or wallets, and prepaid or debit-card apps. Holds, freezes, closures, lockouts, or money leaving the account without the customer's permission go to Bank account or service. Money transfer or service applies only when the customer sent the money and the transfer went wrong or was a scam.	5235, 5265, 5534, 5583, 5578, 5063, 5543, 5527, 5652, 5761, 5986, 5589, 5995, 5055
v1.1	2/10/2026	Rule 2 clarified: if the customer's final request is to correct or delete the credit report entry, choose Credit reporting, even if they also ask the collector for validation or say the debt isn't theirs. Rule 2 takes precedence over the "not theirs" clause in rule 5. Choose Debt collection when the main request is about the collector's conduct, stopping collection, or a refund of money paid to the collector.	5549, 5059, 5107, 5066, 5072
v1.1	2/10/2026	Rule 3 clarified: when identity theft or fraud causes harm in more than one place (for example, card charges and a credit report entry), label by the harm the customer still wants fixed (rule 1).	5837